

Josina Z. Machel

Ms Josina Z. Machel

Activist and Founder Kuhluka Movement

Ms. Josina Z. Machel holds an MSc degree in Sociology (Gender) from the London School of Economics and Political Science and a Bachelor of Social Science, Sociology and Political Science from the University of Cape Town, South Africa.

Ms Machel is also the founder and director of Protect Her Life, an insurance company that seeks to support the safety of women who are subjected to unprecedented levels of gender-based violence. The company provides easily accessible tools to use in the event of abuse or an emergency, by providing comprehensive insurance and emergency assistance packages specially designed for women. The cover is underwritten by Capital Alliance, a division of the Liberty Life group.

Ms Machel was recently elected to be the representative of Survivors of Violence, Mozambique, in the National Interim group at the European Union (EU) and United Nations (UN) new global Spotlight Initiative, which is a new multi-year initiative by the EU and the UN which seeks to eliminate all forms of violence against women and girls (VAWG) and to bring focused attention to this issue, moving it into the spotlight and placing it at the centre of efforts to achieve gender equality and women's empowerment, in line with the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development.

She was also nominated in to the Mama Albertina Sisulu 100 Women of Fortitude. A group of 100 inspirational women who lead the campaign to encourage and revitalize the current generation of South Africans to continue MaSisulu's legacy of activism to better our nation. This campaign will use the stories of the past and present heroines to inspire other women to take charge of their own development.

Over the past 20 years, she has been involved in a number of advocacy and social empowerment programmes to improve perceptions and bring change around social issues impacting the SADC region, including HIV/ AIDS, gender equality, design and coordination of wellness programmes in the workplace.

Her work has primarily been driven by her passion to contribute towards changing communities. Her involvement in advocacy and community empowerment work was in response in to the challenges of HIV/Aids and gender disparities in the workplace.

In 2001, she joined Anglo-American, as its Human Resources Officer, where she was extensively involved in providing policy and strategic insight on issues such as HIV, Wellness and employment equity.

She later joined the Institute for Democracy in South Africa (IDASA), where she was involved in working towards enhancing governance and AIDS programmes, by providing research and analyses around those two specific issues. During this time, she led the programme to address the role of political actors in the AIDS pandemic space.

In 2007, Ms Machel started a consulting and training company Pfukani (Ltd) - the first company in Mozambique to design, coordinate and manage wellness and communication tools for HIV/Aids.

Kuhluka Movement

Following a horrific domestic violence experience that left Ms Machel blind on one eye, in 2015 Ms Machel launch Kuhluka Movement, a non-profit initiative that empowers women survivors of gender based and domestic abuse to find their voice and their feet to walk away from abusive relationships.

Founded on the principles of advocacy and mitigation, Kuhluka bridges

the gap between giving a voice to women survivors, whilst providing them with a safe haven in their time of need.

Kuhluka provides a platform to engage and provide practical solutions to addressing gender-based violence. The movement focuses on preventative measures to stop gender-based violence by bringing custodians of culture together to interrogate practices and traditions that perpetrate gender-based violence, and spark conversations for traditional leaders, men across communities to bring to questions the behaviours that foster an environment that tolerates violence towards women.

Kuhluka Movement aims to provide shelters and a safe haven for women transitioning from abusive relationships to healing and living independent of abusive partners.

Ms Machel is also a motivational speaker on a number of issues aligned to the work of Kuhluka, including the following subjects:

- Leadership and women development
- GBV: 'I may have lost my eye, but I have not lost my vision'
- Economic and financial costs of GBV to business and countries
- Healing and Regeneration : Overcoming adversity
- Building Social Movements
- Cultural practices and the role of traditional leaders in changing community narratives

Awards

Resulting from the work in which Ms Machel has been involved with the Kuhluka Movement, she has won a number of awards for her contributions towards advocacy against gender-based violence, including the following awards:

- Soho Trailblazer Award (USA)
- Fabulous Women Resilience Award (South Africa)
- Game Changer Award (USA)

Current Board membership

The Graca Machel Trust (2010)- a Pan-African advocacy organisation that was founded by Ms Machel's mother, Mrs Graça Machel, which focuses on child health and nutrition, education, women's economic and financial empowerment, leadership and good governance.

The Samora Machel Documentation Centre (2005 – to date) - a private non-profit organization named after Ms Machel's father, Mozambique's deceased first President. The centre was launched in 2005 by Samora Machel's immediate family, colleagues, friends and those who fought alongside him in Mozambique's independence struggle and reflects on Machel's passion for history and his appreciation of the need to preserve a record of the rich past of the Mozambican people.

The Emerald Group in Dubai (2014 -) - a specialist global search and selection company focused on supplying high calibre services across the financial services industry. The Group has three divisional companies namely the Emerald Capital, the Emerald Capital and the Emerald Resources.

She has also served on the following boards:

Atlas Mara BancABC(Mozambique) (2015- 2018) – an investment vehicle founded in 2013 by former Barclays executive Bob Diamond and entrepreneur Ashish Thakkar. Ms Machel headed dutifully the Human Resources and Remuneration committee.

Right to Care (2006-2011) – a non-profit organisation that supports and provides prevention, care and treatment for HIV and associated diseases, namely tuberculosis (TB), cervical cancer and sexually transmitted infections (STIs).

International Women's health coalition(2008-2011) an American non-governmental organization (NGO) founded in 1984 to focus on issues relating to women and girls' human

rights, health and gender equality. It's currently the oldest active global feminist group.